

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9 6 4 2

♥ Q 7 5

♦ 8 7

♣ 10 8

♠ 7

♥ A K J 3

♦ A K 10 5

♣ A Q J 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10

♥ 8 4

♦ J 4 3 2

♣ K 6 5 4 2

♠ J 8 5 3

♥ 10 9 6 2

♦ Q 9 6

♣ 7 3

West

North

East

South

2♠

Dbl

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

Pretty good hand you have. Certainly good enough to make a Takeout Double that forces partner to the 3-level. Partner responds 3♥.

Some questions don't have a correct answer. If partner has ♥ Q x x x along with the ♣K and ♦Q he would bid just as he did and slam would be cold. But if he has four small ♥s and nothing else he would bid just as he did and you probably cannot make ten tricks. On balance it is probably best to just bid the most likely reasonable contract, which is 4♥.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 5 3
♥ 10 9 6
♦ Q 9 7 3
♣ 8 4

♠ A 10 4 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ 8 6

♣ K 10 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K 5 4 2

♣ Q 3 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A K 8

♦ A J 10

♣ A J 9 7

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a perfect 2NT opening hand. Trouble is, the opponents have already opened. You get around that problem by first making a Takeout Double. Partner replies 1 ♠.

You could not say 1NT on your first bid because that would show 15-18 points. Doubling first, then bidding the lowest level of notrump shows 19-20 points. Of course in both cases you must have their suit adequately stopped. Partner does the math and bids 3NT.